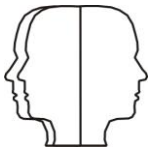
Lesson 24 – Problem Solving: Application



Summary and Rationale

This lesson provides group members the opportunity for collaborative practice of all 6 problem solving skills.

Objectives – As a result of this lesson the group members will be able to apply all 6 problem solving skills to real life situations.

Major Activities

Activity 1: Homework Review
Activity 2: Overview of Lesson
Activity 3: Give Directions for Role Play
Activity 4: Small Groups Plan Role Play
Activity 5: Small Groups Present Role Play
Activity 6: Repeat Activity 5 with Each Small Group
Activity 7: Assign Homework
Activity 8: Wrap-up

Supplements

Charts – Make before facilitating lesson. (See supplement section in each lesson for full text of chart page.)

Denoted in lesson plan with this symbol:

Handouts – Make copies before lesson. (See supplement section of each lesson for camera ready pages.)

Denoted in lesson plan with this symbol:

H-16-1-Problem Solving Skills and Steps (Group members should bring this to class or you should keep a folder with these steps to use each lesson).
H-24-1–Problem Solving Role Play Directions
H-24-2-Problem Solving Role Play Plan
H-24-3-Homework
H-24-4-Program Organizer Activity

Presentation Slides – Make transparencies if projector is not available. (See supplement section of each lesson for camera ready pages.)

Denoted in lesson plan with this symbol:

P-24-1-Title Slide
P-24-2-Homework Review
P-24-3–The 6 Problem Solving Skills
P-24-4-Skill 1: Stop and Think
P-24-5-Skill 2: State the Problem
P-24-6-Skill 3: Set a Goal and Gather Information
P-24-7-Skill 4: Think of Choices and Consequences
P24-8-Skill 5: Make a Plan
P-24-9-Skill 6: Do and Evaluate
P-24-10-Homework
P-24-11-Program Organizer

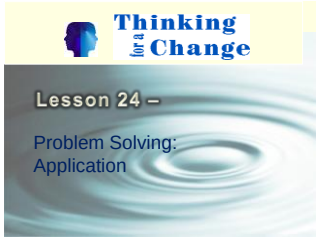
Equipment	Supplies
▪ Easel (chart stand) ▪ Projector to show presentation slides ▪ Projection screen or suitable surface	▪ Chart paper ▪ Markers ▪ Masking tape ▪ Copies of participant handouts

Content	Notes

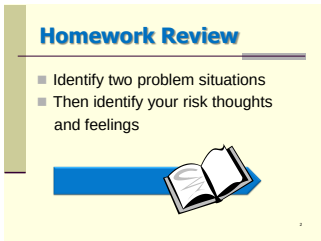
Activity 1: Homework Review

For your homework, I asked you to identify two problem situations. Let's start with *(name a group member)* and find out what problems each of you have identified. Also tell us the risk thoughts, feelings, and attitudes and beliefs you identified.

P-24-1



P-24-2



Activity 2: Overview of the Lesson

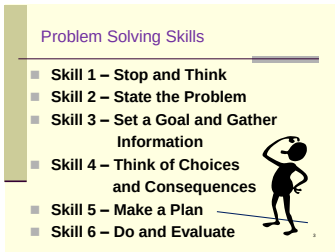
Great work on that homework review! In this lesson we will have an opportunity to put into action everything we have learned in problem solving.

Each of you will work with a small group.

You will pick two or three problem situations your group would like to work with, then we will work together to choose one for the role play.

Using the agreed upon situation, each small group will work together to plan a role play that shows how to deal with the problem.

P-24-3



Place group members in small groups of 3 to 5 individuals.

Each group needs to have members who are adequate readers/writers.

You will coach the groups

Content	Notes
The role play needs to show what each of the six problem solving skills could look like for your situation. Finally, you will do your role play for the whole group.	about which problem to use so that you have a variety of problem situations presented to the large group. Your coaching in problem selection will also help ensure that group members have successful experiences. For example, a role play that is complicated or overly emotionally charged may not be suited to having the group members successfully practice the problem solving skills.
Activity 3: Give Directions for the Problem Solving Role Plays For planning, identify someone who will write down the information for each of the skills and steps. You will decide what information goes into each step as a group. Then choose a role for each group member to take on in the role play. Here are the roles: 1. **Narrator:** This person introduces each skill.	H-24-1-Problem Solving Role Play Directions

Content	Notes
After the skill has been demonstrated, the narrator asks the group to identify the different steps of the skill. 2. **Problem solver:** This is the person who will be showing each of the problem solving skills. For example, for skill 1: **stop and think**, this person will identify his/her warning signs and show how to be quiet, get space and calm down. 3. **Co-actors:** The others in your group will take the role of others who are involved in the problem or the problem solving process. After you finish planning each skill, let me know. I want to go over each step as you plan it.	
Activity 4: Small Groups Plan Role Play	Help each small group pick a problem situation that lends itself well to a role play. H-24-2-Problem Solving Role Play Plan Monitor and assist as needed with small group planning. Check each skill as they plan it and provide feedback to help make

Content	Notes
	each step clear and not too detailed. Help each small group do a brief practice of the role play before they actually perform it. Find out who the narrator is going to be and tell the narrator to use his/her lesson 16-1 handout to introduce and debrief each problem solving skill.
Activity 5: Small Group Presents Role Play Let's begin by having the narrator give us some background information: • What is the problem situation you are going to show us? • Is this an "in your face" or "time to think" problem? • What role is each group member playing?	Identify the first group to present. H-16-1 Problem Solving Skills and Steps. Group members can refer to this sheet as they observe role plays.

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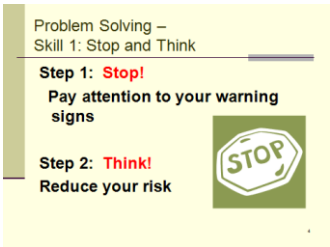
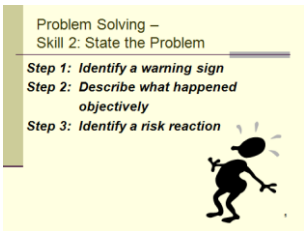
Problem Solving Skill 1: Stop and Think We will now watch how this problem begins with the **stop and think** skill.	P-24-4  If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if necessary prompt the narrator to ask other group members what they observed.
Problem Solving Skill 2: State the Problem	P-24-5  If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if

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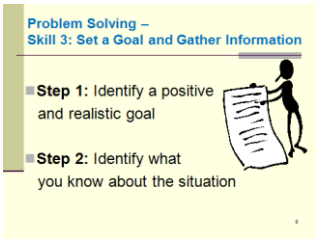
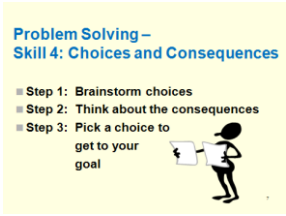
Problem Solving Skill 3: Set a Goal and Gather Information	P-24-6  If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if necessary prompt the narrator to ask other group members what they observed.
Problem Solving Skill 4: Think of Choices and Consequences	P-24-7  If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this

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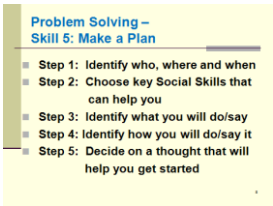
	skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if necessary prompt the narrator to ask other group members what they observed.
Problem Solving Skill 5: Make a Plan	P-24-8  If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if necessary prompt the narrator to ask other group members what they observed.
Problem Solving Skill 6: Do and Evaluate	P-24-9

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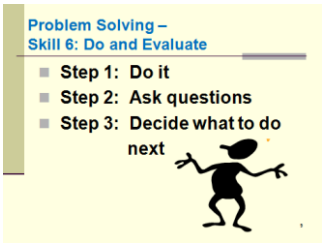
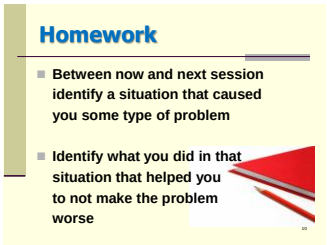
	 If necessary prompt the narrator to introduce this skill. When the role play for this skill is finished, if necessary prompt the narrator to ask other group members what they observed.
Activity 6: Repeat Activity 5 with each Small Group Which small group would like to go next?	Repeat activity 5 with each small group. Every small group must role play a situation that demonstrates all six of the problem solving skills.
Activity 7: Assign Homework Congratulations, you have worked together to	P-25-10

Content	Notes

show how the six problem solving skills can apply to different situations.

- Between now and next session identify a situation that caused you some type of problem.
- It can be a minor problem like having to wait in line when you don't want to or a major problem that could result in a fight.
- Identify what you did in that situation that helped you not make the problem worse.



H-24-3-Homework

Activity 8: Wrap-up with Program Organizer

Now that we have finished learning the six skills of problem solving, and using all your knowledge and experience from both cognitive self-change and social skills, let's take one final look at our program organizer.

Display the program organizer and give the group a few moments to study it.

P-25-11

Here are some of the statements that you have identified during your previous encounters with the program organizer.

Either display the chart papers with the comments from earlier

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	program organizer discussions (lesson 1, activity 6; lesson 9, activity 8; and lesson 16, activity 2) or read some of the comments that were saved.
Small Group Discussion	
We are going to break into work groups and I will give you a worksheet with some questions.	Break the group into three or four subgroups for a small group activity.
After we break up into the work groups, you will have ten minutes to study the program organizer and respond to the questions.	You can have the group members count off by three's or four's and then combine like numbers together to form groups, or use any other appropriate method.
Have one of your group members prepare to report to all of us what the product of your work is.	
Here is a group activity sheet that has several questions for you to consider as you revisit and study the program organizer. Answer each question as a group and prepare to share your ideas with the rest of us.	H–24–3-Program Organizer Summary Distribute the Group Activity Sheet. Allow 10 minutes for the groups to work.
Discussion	Ask the spokesperson

Content	Notes
Let's hear from the spokesperson of each group. Who would like to go first?	for each group to report out their ideas.
We have now wrapped up all three components of **Thinking for a Change**. Congratulations on all your good work.	